

ULTIMATE SMARTPHONE BUYING CHEAT-SHEET

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The festive season has begun in full swing and so have the flurry of sales across e-commerce platforms.

Now's the best time to invest in a new smartphone if you've been holding off on buying one. However, with the number of options crowding the market, it can be hard to decipher what suits your needs the best. To that end, here are some things you must remember when buying a smartphone in 2023.

1 Higher number ≠ Better Performance

One would think an SoC with a higher number in its name would obviously



be more powerful. While this stands true most of the time, there are some exceptions. For example, the Snapdragon 7 Gen 2 clocks higher scores in synthetic benchmarks than

the Snapdragon 8 Gen 1. It also stays cooler and is more efficient. So, we recommend reading about the processors before taking the plunge just based on nomenclature.

2 Types of displays

There are two basic types of panels – OLED and LCD. OLED screens are often seen on more premium

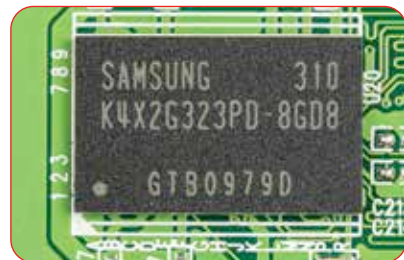


offerings since they offer purer blacks, more vibrant colours, and consume less energy when dark colours are displayed. If your budget is between ₹15K-20K, I would suggest looking for phones with OLED/AMOLED screens because of the benefits they offer. Additionally, ensure to check out phones with reliable display protection.

3 Virtual RAM is not real RAM

Several phones in 2023 falsely advertise how much RAM they have. For example, a phone's marketing

material could say it has 8 GB RAM under ₹10,000 but reading the fine print reveals that this is actually 4 GB actual onboard RAM + 4 GB virtual RAM.



Virtual RAM uses a part of the phone's internal storage to serve as makeshift RAM. Note, that this extra RAM is not as fast as the real deal and it could also reduce your internal storage's lifespan because of the constant reading and writing happening that's harmful for flash memory.

4 128 GB phones shouldn't be on your radar now

The generation of 64 and 128 GB storage phones is gone now, in our opinion. Especially when it comes to



high-end or flagship phones. Opting for 128 GB models may seem appealing due to the cost-saving aspect but this essentially speeds up your phone's expiry date. App and multimedia size has increased significantly over the years. If your phone's storage is full or close to full, your phone will tend to lag considerably which can sour user experience and impact the device longevity overall.

5 5G is the future

With 5G connectivity becoming more prevalent across the country, we